

Topic 3 – Distinctive Landscapes

The UK contains a diverse and distinct range of landscapes. This topic gives learners the opportunity to unravel the geographical processes that make them distinctive. A deeper understanding of the geomorphic

processes that shape river and coastal landscapes is developed and consideration of the human influence on these.

3.1. What makes a landscape distinctive?		Scale
a. What is a landscape?	How the concept of a landscape can be defined, including the differences between built and natural landscapes.	R, L, F
b. Where are the physical landscapes of the UK?	Overview of the distribution of upland, lowland and glaciated landscapes in the UK.	N
	Overview of the characteristics of these landscapes which make them distinctive including their geology, climate and human activity.	
3.2. What influences the landscapes of the UK?		
a. What physical processes shape landscapes?	- The geomorphic processes that are involved in shaping landscapes, including weathering (mechanical, chemical, biological), mass movement (sliding, slumping), erosion (abrasion, hydraulic action, attrition, solution), transport (traction, saltation, suspension, solution), deposition. - The formation of coastal landforms including headlands, bays, cave, arch, stack, beach and spit. - The formation of river landforms including waterfall, gorge, v-shaped valley, floodplain, levee, meander, ox-bow lake.	L, F
b. What are the characteristics of your chosen landscapes?	Case study of two landscapes in the UK, one coastal landscape and one river basin, to include the study of: - its landforms created by geomorphic processes - the geomorphic processes operating at different scales and how they are influenced by geology and climate - how human activity, including management, works in combination with geomorphic processes to impact the landscape.	R, L, F